

**What a maths
report actually
tells you, and
what it hides.**

A percentage is an average of averages

62 percent could be strong algebra and collapsed geometry, or steady mediocrity across everything. The two need completely different responses, and the number cannot tell them apart.

'Could apply himself more' usually means something specific

Ask which topic the teacher was thinking of when they wrote it. Nine times out of ten there is one concrete moment behind that sentence.

Effort grades measure compliance, not learning

A child who is quietly lost often scores well on effort. They are working hard on the wrong thing, which is the most expensive kind of hard work.

Ask for the question-level breakdown

Most schools have it and rarely send it. It shows exactly which topics cost the marks, which is the only thing you can actually act on.



**Save this before the
next report evening.**

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